1.NATURAL RESOURCES:

All resources that have been directly provided by nature are called **Natural resources**. The air, water, soil, minerals, natural vegetation and wild life around us are all natural resources. The use of any natural resource depends on the place it is available, the form in which it is available and the technology necessary to avail it.



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CLASSIFICATION OF NATURAL RESOURCES

Natural resources can be classified into different groups depending on **origin, development, renewability, distribution, ownership etc**.

A.ON THE BASIS OF ORIGIN:

On the basis of **origin,** resources can be classified into biotic and abiotic resources.

i. All living resources are biotic resources, plants, animals and other micro organisms are **biotic resources**.



ii. **Abiotic resources** are non-living things. Land, water, air and minerals are abiotic resources.

The biotic resources were mere substances till they were recognized by humans. According to the human needs the substances were collected by the ancient men and preserved for use. In the beginning ,man had only three basic needs- food, clothing and shelter. He collected things through **primary activities** such as hunting, food gathering, fishing and forestry. Later when food became scarce, they had to cultivate and that became agriculture and the cattle were also reared on their farms to fulfill their basic needs.



The abiotic resources were also sought after by the early men. They went in search of better landforms where they had enough water resources for agriculture and their cattle. They were in need of tools right from hunting to agriculture. Primarily the tools were only made of stones. Later man dug the earth for better abiotic resources and found copper first and iron later. He also mined precious metals simultaneously for making ornaments. Later mining became one of the leading primary activities and still holds an important place among the economic activities.

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